Rizal Law

Reasons Why Some Groups Opposed the Rizal Law

Main Oppositors:

- Catholic Church groups

Reasons for Opposition:

- **Noli Me Tangere and El Filibusterismo criticized friars** and some Church practices during the Spanish period.
- They believed the novels were **attacks on the Catholic faith**, not just on abuses.
- Concern that reading the **unexpurgated (complete) versions** might:
    - Confuse students
    - Weaken their religious beliefs
- Claimed the law **violated freedom of religion**.

Important Clarification:

- Rizal criticized **abuses and corruption**, not religion itself.
- His goal was to expose injustice, not destroy Catholicism.

Key Idea to Remember:

Education should:

- Promote **critical thinking**
- Teach the **truth about history**
- Strengthen **nationalism and patriotism**

Is the Rizal Law a “Compromised Law”?

YES – It is considered a compromised law.

Why?

- Government made adjustments to satisfy opposing groups.
- Included a **religious exemption clause**:
    - Students may be excused from reading unexpurgated versions if it conflicts with their faith.
    - BUT they still need to take the Rizal course.

Purpose of the Compromise:

- Reduce conflict between Church and State
- Respect **religious freedom**
- Still achieve the main goal:
  → Teach Rizal’s life and works
  → Promote nationalism

Key Concept:

Compromise = Not everyone fully satisfied, but the law was passed and its main objective was achieved.

Choosing the National Hero

Criteria of a True National Hero:

- Deep love for the country
- Inspires people to fight for freedom
- Makes great sacrifices
- Leaves lasting impact in history
- Awakens national identity and unity

Why Choose Jose Rizal?

- Used **intelligence and writings**, not violence.
- Noli and El Fili exposed:
    - Colonial abuses
    - Social injustices
- Awakened Filipino nationalism.
- Inspired critical thinking.
- Sacrificed his life for the country.
- His ideas became the foundation of the revolution.

Important Reminder:

- Rizal as National Hero does NOT mean others are less important.
- Other heroes:
    - Andres Bonifacio
    - Antonio Luna
    - And many more
- Philippine freedom was achieved by **many heroes**, not just one.

Opposition Reasons:
Faith – Friars – Freedom of Religion – Fear of Confusion

Compromised Law:
Religious Exemption – Balance – Nationalism + Religious Freedom

Why Rizal:
Writings – Nationalism – Sacrifice – Inspiration

RIZAL'S CENTURY (The Philippines a Century Hence)

19th Century – Background

Age of Enlightenment

- Dito nag-start yung ideas about **freedom, liberty, and equality**.
- Kumalat ito dahil sa **printing press** (mas mabilis na pagkalat ng ideas).
- Dito rin nag-rise ang **liberalism** sa Europe.
- People started questioning authority, especially monarchy and church power.

Meaning: Hindi na basta sumusunod ang tao, gusto na nila ng rights at representation.

Political Context – Rise of Nationalism

- Maraming bansa ang gustong maging independent.
- May mga civil wars dahil sa conflicts sa territory at power.
- Sa Spain mismo, may hati ang mga intellectuals:

Liberals vs Conservatives

Liberal

- Focus sa **individual freedom**.
- Ayaw masyado ng government control.
- Gusto nila **laissez-faire** (free economy, less taxes, less interference).
- Naniniwala sila na kaya ng tao mag-decide for themselves.
- “Less control, more freedom.”

Conservative

- Focus sa **social order and stability**.
- Okay lang sa kanila ang government intervention.
- Naniniwala sila na kailangan ng guidance ang tao.
- Priority ang social welfare at kaayusan ng society.
- “Order before freedom.”

Basically: Freedom vs Stability.

🇵🇭 19th Century Philippines (Under Spain)

Political Situation

- May **union of Church and State** (malakas ang influence ng friars sa government).
- Under Spanish Constitution of 1876.
- Maraming corrupt officials.
- Walang Filipino representation sa **Spanish Cortes** (parliament ng Spain).
- Denied ang human rights ng Filipinos.
- Walang equality before the law.
- May racial discrimination (mataas ang tingin sa Spaniards).
- May **frailocracy** – friars ang may malaking power.
- May forced labor (polo y servicios).
- Friars owned huge haciendas (land).
- May Guardia Civil (parang military police) na strict at abusive.

Meaning: Hindi equal ang trato sa Filipinos. Kontrolado ng Spain at simbahan ang halos lahat.

Secularization Movement

- **Secular priests** = Filipino priests.
- **Regular/Friars** = Spanish religious orders.
- Conflict kasi inalis ang Filipino priests sa parishes at pinalitan ng Spanish friars.
- Isa ito sa dahilan ng Gomburza issue.

Dito nag-start mas ma-intensify ang nationalism.

Economic Context

- May **Galleon Trade** (Manila-Acapulco).
- Ginamit ang Philippines para mag-export ng products like tobacco, rice, etc.
- Colonized country lang tayo na nagsisilbi sa economic interest ng Spain.
- Filipinos worked hard pero Spain ang nakinabang.

Social Structure (Hierarchy)

May social ranking noon:

1. Peninsulares – Spaniards born in Spain (highest)
2. Insulares – Spaniards born in PH
3. Mestizos - mixed filo and foreign
4. Indios – Native Filipinos (lowest)

Meaning: Hindi pantay ang society. Based sa race ang status.

Takeaways (Simple Explanation)

- Enlightenment ideas influenced Filipino ilustrados (like Rizal).
- Injustice + discrimination = rise of nationalism.
- Rizal was analyzing:
  "If Spain continues abusing the Philippines, magre-revolt ba tayo?"
  "Magiging independent ba ang Philippines in the future?"

Do we still see these situations today?

Yes, in some ways:

- May political division pa rin (liberal vs conservative).
- May corruption pa rin.
- May social inequality pa rin.
- May issues pa rin about human rights.
- May tension pa rin minsan between church and state.

But:

- Independent na ang Philippines.
- May representation na tayo.
- May constitution at legal protection ng rights.

MGA LIHIM NG PAMILYA NI RIZAL (Documentary by Howie Severino)

Basic Family Facts

- Rizal had 11 siblings (He was the 7th child).
- He was called “Niño Bonito” by his family.
- He was very intelligent at a young age.
- He was very close to his mother.

Doña Teodora Alonzo

- Rizal’s first teacher.
- She taught him reading, writing, and good values.
- She played a major role in developing his intelligence and love for learning.

Injustice Experienced by the Family

- When Rizal was 10 years old, his mother was wrongly accused and imprisoned.
- The accusation came from Teodora Formoso, who claimed that Doña Teodora tried to poison her.
- Doña Teodora’s brother was Jose Alberto.
- This incident exposed Rizal early to injustice and abuse of power.

Family Background

- Rizal’s family was not “perfect.”
- They experienced conflicts, legal problems, and misunderstandings.
- Despite this, they remained strong and supportive of one another.

Important Insight from the Documentary

According to Barbara Gonzales (apo sa tuhod ni Rizal):
“Anybody can be a hero, and it doesn’t have to be someone with a beautiful family background.”

Meaning:

- A hero does not need a perfect family.
- Personal struggles and hardships can shape a person’s character and purpose.

How Rizal’s Family Influenced His Life

- His mother shaped his intelligence, discipline, and moral values.
- Seeing his mother suffer injustice at a young age opened his eyes to the reality of oppression.
- This experience deepened his understanding of social injustice.
- His complex family background motivated him to fight for reforms.
- His early experiences helped form his strong sense of justice and nationalism.

WHO IS JOSE RIZAL?

Full Name
Jose Protacio Realonda Alonzo Mercado Rizal

Birth Information

- Born: June 19, 1861
- Place: Calamba, Laguna
- Nickname: Pepe / Pepito

Meaning of His Name

- Jose – From San Jose (Saint Joseph); reflects the family's strong religious background.
- Protacio – Came from the calendar of saints; during that time, children were often given names based on the saint's feast day.
- Realonda Alonzo – From his mother's side (Doña Teodora Alonzo).
- Mercado – The family's original surname; associated with "market" or merchants (marque), showing their business background.
- Rizal – Means "green field," reflecting the family's agricultural roots.

About the Mercado Family

- The Mercado family was relatively wealthy.
- They were engaged in agriculture and business.
- They were close to Spanish friars, which helped them gain influence and stability.
- Despite being well-off, they still experienced injustice and legal problems.

Rizal's Siblings (Rizal Children)

1. Saturnina Rizal-Hidalgo (Neneng)
2. Paciano Rizal
3. Narcisa Rizal-Lopez (Sisa)
4. Olympia Rizal-Ubaldo (Ypia)
5. Lucia Rizal-Herbosa
6. Maria Rizal-Cruz (Biang)
7. Jose Rizal (Pepe)
8. Concepcion Rizal (Concha)
9. Josefa Rizal (Panggoy)
10. Trinidad Rizal (Trining)
11. Soledad Rizal-Quintero (Choleng)

- Rizal was the 7th child in a family of 11 children.

Jose Rizal's First Heartbreak

- His first heartbreak was the death of his younger sister, Concepcion (Concha).
- Concha died at a young age.
- Her death deeply affected Rizal and was one of his earliest emotional pains.

EARLY CHILDHOOD OF RIZAL

3 uncles who added inspiration to him

- Gregorio Alberto - work hard to think for himself and observe life keenly
- Jose - sketch paint and sculpt
- Manuel - swimming fencing wrestling and other sport

Rizal was an Elitist
First Tutor - Leon Monroy
Jesuits are not considered as Friars

Maestro Justiniano Aquino Cruz
- Former Teacher of Paciano (Rizal's Brother)
- Was strict (uses short thin stick to discipline students)

Rizal's Choice of School
1. Colegio De San Juan De Letran
2. Ateneo Municipal
    - Former name "Escuela Pia" (Charity School)
    - Was a Public School
    - Was under supervision of the Spanish Jesuits
3. San Jose Seminary

Chinese are not allowed to enter Intramuros
Dominicans bought Binondo for Catholic Chinese

Father Magin Ferrando
- Refused to admit Rizal in Ateneo (1. Was late for registration. 2. Undersized for his age)

Manuel Xerez Burgos
- Was admitted because of him

Rizal was not good at Spanish before
So he took his lesson at Santa Isabel College during recesses. Paid 3 Pesos for Spanish Lessons
Magallanes was where Rizal lived

Padre Francisco de Paula Sanchez
- A great educator and scholar
- Rizal's literally mentor
- Rizal's Inspiration

Rizal was 16 years old when he received
Ateneo Municipal, Bachelor of Arts, with Highest Honors (Sobre Siliente)

Medical Studies at the University of Santo Tomas
- Philosophy in letters (1st course) because of his father and he was still undecided
- Will transfer to medicine as he wants to cure his mother's failing eyesight
- Rizal was unhappy in UST so he made Companerismo (Comradeship) which is a secret society of Filipino student in UST
- The Dominican professors were hostile to him
- Filipinos were racially discriminated by the spaniards
- Method of instruction was obsolete and repressive (makaluma)

Also studied in Ateneo. Vocational course leading to the title of perito agrimensor (expert surveyor)
Leonor Rivera was his greatest love

BOOKS THE INFLUENCE RIZAL

- The Count of Monte Cristo by Alexander
- Universal History by Cesar Cantu
- Travel in the Philippines by Dr. Feodor Jagor

Rizal Travels after UST

Jose Rizal After UST

May 3, 1882
Spain
- He secretly left the Philippines and only his brother and other 2 sister knew
- His purpose was to finish his studies but he went for a secret mission

Barcelona
- He met some of his classmates from ateneo
- Started writing for the Diariong Tagalog under the pseudonym “Laong Laan” meaning Ever prepared

Madrid
- El Amor Patrio meaning Love of Country published but was suspended because of his mother’s opposition
- Enrolled in Universidad Central de Madrid and took medicine, philosophy in letters
- Joined the Circulo Hispano-Filipino

1884
- Rizal made a speech at the banquet and it was published in the b=magazine “los dos mundos” and the day after he got famous

1885
- Finished his licentiate in Philosophy in Letters

Paris
- Moved to specialized ophthalmologist
- worked for Dr. Louis de Wecker a known French ophthalmologist for using scissors for surgeries
- met with juan luna and became a model for 2 paintings
- half finished noli me tangere

1886
Germany
- moved to germany due to high cost in paris
- worked as an assistant to Dr. Otto Becker
- he met Blumentritt

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Leipzig
- Attended lecture
- he quickly learned german language
- later on he translated some german works in Tagalog
- William Tell one of his translated works
- also some works of Hans Christian Andersen such as Thumbelina, The Little Matchgirl,

Berlin
- wanted to learn more ophthalmology, german culture and government, and to meet with scientists
- worked as an assistant in the clinic of Dr. Schweiggerin the morning
- attending classes at night at the University of Berlin
- wanted to publish noli me tanger but was sick, poor, and sad
- eats bread everyday to save money which lead him to be diagnose with tuberculosis
- he was visited by his friend Maximo Viola in Berlin and lend him money for allowance to published noli me tangere

1887
- 2k copies of the book were produced and distributed to Filipinos including Blumintritt
- With the help of Viola Rizal visited Germany, Switzerland, and Austria
- After a visit to Vienna, Rome and more he took a trip back home on
July 5, 1887
- to operate on his mother

PROPAGANDA MOVEMENT

The propaganda movement published its own newspaper which is the La Solidaridad. Graciano Lopez Jaena was the first author then later on took over by Marcelo H. del Pilar (1889)

PHILIPPINES
- returned after 5 years abroad
- friars were mad and was determined to silence rizal because of the book
- they rumor rizal as a german spy as a result rizal received death threats that made his family worried
- established a medical clinic and his first patient was his mother
- and was known as an eye specialist and surgeon
- was called Doctor Uliman as he was mistaken as german

August 1887
- Left calamba for manila to meet Governor-General Emilio Terrero (liberal minded Spanish Official) to talk about his novel and the governor found nothing wrong but the archibishops argued that it was against them and should be stoped
- the friars got mad and wanted rizal to leave the country but the governor refuses but suggested that he leave for his own good and was agreed by the family of rizal
- after 6 months in the Philippines he left for Hongkong

Hongkong
- he met Filipino exiles Jose Maria Basa, Balabino Mauricio, and Manuel Yriarte
- Studied Chinese language
- became friend with the governor general's secretary Jose Joaquin Barrada

Japan
- stayed at a hotel for days
- got invited by Juan Perez Caballero to live at the Spanish Legation for a month
- learned japanese language
- met O-sei-san and became friend to lovers

1888
USA
- his ship was quarantined in San Francisco, suspected as carrying cholera
- he saw how the potential of the country but realized that it lacks racial equality
- was disturbed by the unfair treatment towards the japanese and chinese people

London
- moved to improve his english
- met Dr. Reinhold Rost (librarian of the ministry of foreign affairs in England) which allowed Rizal to undertake research at a museum

1889
Paris
- to continue writing El FIlibustirismo (sequel of Noli Me Tangere)
- also continued the research on the Philippines History

1890
Belgium
- remind Marcelo that they went to europe for freedom not to gamble
- heard news that his family and relatives had been evicted from their land in calamba
- Rizal got mad that the friars are taking advantage and was determined to get revenge so he wrote a poem entitled "A Mi Musa" (to my muse) and was published on La Solidaridad to call for justice

Madrid
- completed the draft of el filibusterismo
1890
- had a conflict with del pilar as they had a different views in politics
- won as Respondable but declined then left La Solidaridad

1891
- attended gathering of Filipinos and had a conflict with Antonio Luna because of a girl named Nellie Boustead which lead to a duel but later on Luna apologized to Rizal

Hongkong

- went after publishing el filibusterismo in europe
- practice his medical
- family also went and celebrated christmas
- began writing the constitution of La Liga Filipina with the help of Jose Maria Basa
- wrote 2 articles 1. To the Spanish Nation 2. To my countrymen
- met William Pryer (managed the British North Borneo Company

Jose Rizal After UST (1882–1892)
With Exact Dates and Events

1882

May 3, 1882 – Philippines → Spain

- Rizal secretly left the Philippines for the first time.
- He boarded the ship Salvadora using the passport name Jose Mercado.
- Only his brother Paciano and two sisters knew about his departure.
- His purpose was to finish his studies and secretly observe European society and politics.

June 15, 1882 – Barcelona, Spain

- Rizal arrived in Barcelona from Marseilles by express train.
- Met some of his Ateneo classmates.

August 20, 1882 – Barcelona

- His article “Amor Patrio” (Love of Country) was published in Diariong Tagalog.
- It was his first article written abroad.
- He used the pseudonym Laong Laan meaning *Ever Prepared*.

September 2, 1882 – Madrid, Spain

- Rizal matriculated at the Universidad Central de Madrid.
- He studied Medicine and Philosophy and Letters.
- Joined the Circulo Hispano-Filipino.

October 4, 1882 – Madrid

- Rizal recited the poem “Me Piden Versos” after being asked by members of the Circulo Hispano-Filipino.

November 2, 1882 – Madrid

- Rizal wrote the article “Revista de Madrid” intended for Diariong Tagalog, but it was not published because the newspaper stopped circulation.

November 7, 1882 – Madrid

- Rizal wrote the article “Las Dulas”, signed Laong-Laan.

1883

June 18, 1883 – Paris, France

- Rizal visited Leannec Hospital with Felipe Zamora and Cunanan.
- Observed Dr. Nicaise treating patients.

June 19, 1883 – Paris

- Again visited Dr. Nicaise who demonstrated surgical techniques.
- Later visited the Dupuytren Museum.

June 20, 1883 – Paris

- Visited Lariboisiere Hospital.
- Observed examination of different diseases of women.

September 28, 1883 – Madrid

- Rizal enrolled again at Universidad Central de Madrid for the second course in medicine.

October 1883 – Madrid

- Rizal learned about the imprisonment of 14 innocent rich Filipinos in Manila ordered by Vicente Barrantes.

1884

January 2, 1884 – Madrid

- Rizal proposed to the Circulo Hispano-Filipino the idea of publishing a book by association.
- This idea became the beginning of Noli Me Tangere.

June 21, 1884 – Madrid

- Rizal finished the Licentiate in Medicine with the grade aprobado.

June 25, 1884 – Madrid

- Rizal delivered a famous speech honoring Filipino painters Juan Luna and Felix Hidalgo.
- Their victory in the art competition made Filipinos proud.

July 1, 1884 – Madrid

- Rizal explained the meaning of “Filibusterismo” in the newspaper El Progreso.

November 20, 1884 – Madrid

- Rizal witnessed a student and professor strike at the university protesting the bishop’s interference in academic freedom.

1886

April 22, 1886 – Heidelberg, Germany

- Rizal wrote the poem “A Las Flores de Heidelberg.”

During this period:

- Studied ophthalmology.
- Worked with Dr. Otto Becker.
- Learned the German language.
- Translated works such as:
    - William Tell
    - Thumbelina
    - The Little Match Girl

He later moved to Berlin:

- Worked with Dr. Schweigger.
- Attended classes at the University of Berlin.
- Continued writing Noli Me Tangere despite poverty and illness.
- Survived mostly on bread to save money.

His friend Maximo Viola later helped him publish the novel.

1887

March 21, 1887 – Berlin, Germany

- Noli Me Tangere was published.
- Around 2000 copies were printed.
- Rizal sent copies to Filipino friends including Ferdinand Blumentritt.

August 5, 1887 – Manila, Philippines

- Rizal returned to the Philippines after 5 years abroad.

August 18, 1887 – Philippines

- Archbishop Pedro Payo ordered the University of Santo Tomas to investigate Noli Me Tangere.

August 30, 1887 – Manila

- Rizal left Calamba for Manila to meet Governor-General Emilio Terrero regarding the novel.
- The University of Santo Tomas commission also prohibited the reading of the novel.

September 1887 – Calamba

- Rizal decided to stay with his family for the meantime.

October 19, 1887 – Los Baños

- Rizal made a pencil drawing of a sailboat on Laguna de Bay during an excursion with Jose Taviel de Andrade.

December 29, 1887 – Philippines

- The Board of Censors officially prohibited the circulation of Noli Me Tangere.

1888

February 3, 1888 – Manila

- Rizal left the Philippines for Hong Kong after staying for almost 6 months.
- He brought 5000 pesos from his medical practice.

February 19, 1888 – Hong Kong

- With Jose Maria Basa and others, Rizal traveled to Macao on the ship Kui Kiang.

February 22, 1888 – Hong Kong → Japan

- Rizal left for Japan aboard the ship Oceanic.

In Japan:

- Stayed at the Spanish Legation.
- Learned Japanese language.
- Met O-Sei-San, who later became his romantic partner.

1890

August 23, 1890 – Madrid, Spain

- Rizal wrote Juan Luna explaining his conflict with Antonio Luna (related to Nellie Boustead).

1891

March 29, 1891 – Biarritz, France

- Rizal finished writing El Filibusterismo.

May 1, 1891 – Brussels, Belgium

- In a letter to Jose Maria Basa, Rizal expressed his desire to move to Hong Kong.

May 30, 1891 – Brussels

- Rizal prepared 20 chapters of El Filibusterismo for printing.

July 9, 1891 – Ghent, Belgium

- Rizal suffered financial difficulties because he had not received money from home for three months.

September 1891 – Ghent

- El Filibusterismo was finally published with financial help from friends.

1892

June 26, 1892 – Philippines

- Rizal returned to the Philippines on the ship Don Juan.
- Attended a meeting at the house of Don Ong-junco.

July 3, 1892 – Manila

- Rizal had an interview with Governor-General Despujol.
- In the evening, he attended a meeting at Calle Ylaya discussing the creation of La Liga Filipina.

July 6, 1892 – Manila

- Rizal had his last interview with the Governor-General.
- Anti-friar pamphlets were allegedly found in his sister Lucia's baggage.
- He was imprisoned at Fort Santiago.

July 15, 1892 – Philippines → Dapitan

- Rizal was exiled to Dapitan aboard the ship S.S. Cebu.